Governance at Scale

Snowflake Activation Webinar Series

Snowflake Account Engineering Team

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WHEN TRUSTED ACCESS EXPOSES THE WRONG DATA

A valid login does not guarantee the right data reached the right person.

- A legitimate user opens a trusted dashboard and sees sensitive data they do not need.
- The access looked normal. The exposure was not.
- Who saw what, and can you prove which controls were enforced?

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WHY SCALE BREAKS GOVERNANCE

- ACCESS GROWS
- Direct grants and role sprawl become hard to explain.

- CONTEXT DRIFTS
- The same sensitive data is labeled and protected differently.

- EVIDENCE ARRIVES LATE
- Teams reconstruct exposure after trust is already damaged.

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GOVERNANCE OUTCOMES

- Useful access · RBAC patterns
- Consistent context · tag + classify
- Consistent protection · column + row security
- Defensible evidence · Access History
- Your design · tailored AE working session

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HOW THE CONTROLS WORK TOGETHER

Decide access → understand data → enforce policy → prove outcomes.

1 DECIDE ACCESS

RBAC creates an explainable path.

2 UNDERSTAND DATA

Tags and classification identify risk.

3 ENFORCE POLICY

Mask values and filter rows.

4 PROVE OUTCOMES

Link activity to controls.

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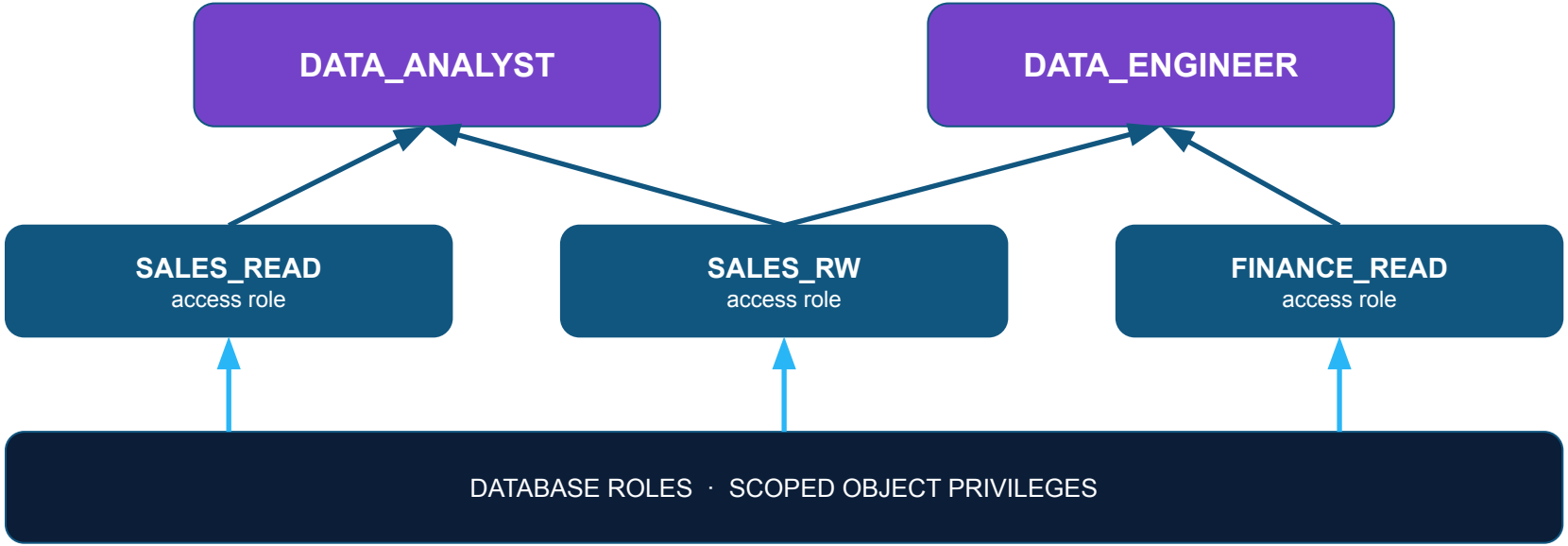
WHEN RBAC DOES NOT SCALE

- DIRECT USER GRANTS
- Access depends on individual exceptions.
- DUPLICATED ROLE LOGIC
- Similar jobs accumulate different privileges.
- UNCLEAR OWNERSHIP
- No reusable layer explains why access exists.
- THE SHIFT
- Put privileges in reusable access roles. Grant those roles to functional roles.

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RBAC PATTERNS: ONE CONTROLLED ACCESS PATH

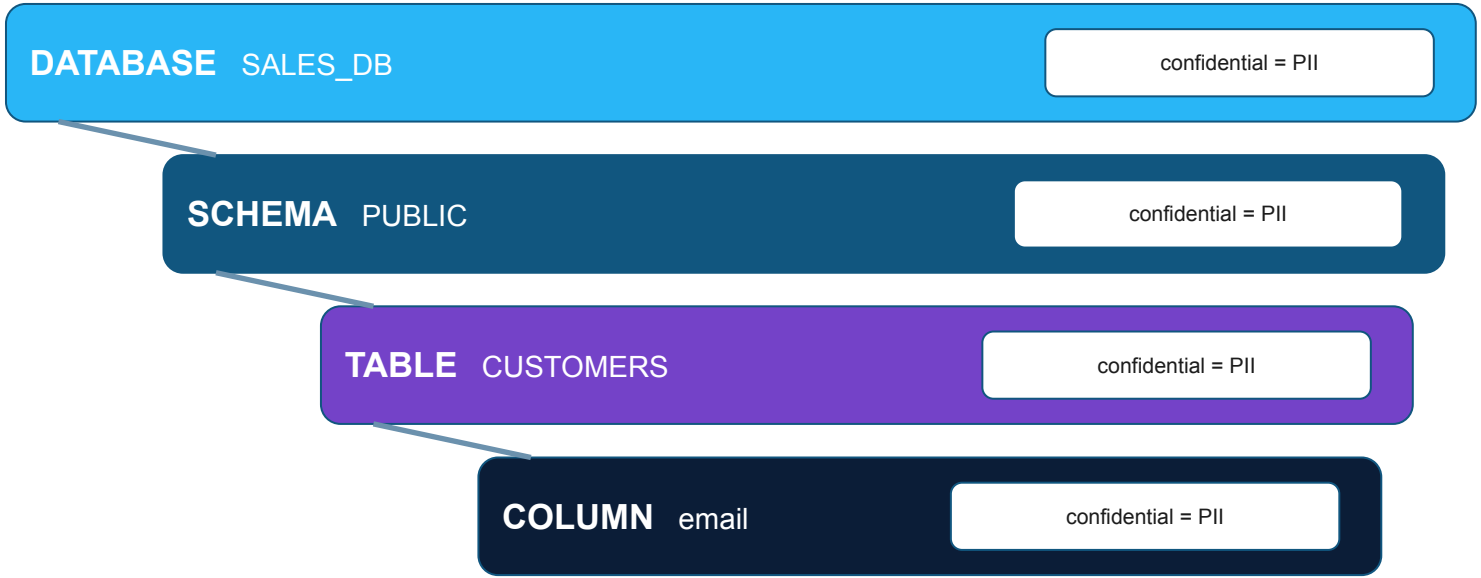
SCOPED DATABASE ROLE → ACCESS ROLE → FUNCTIONAL ROLE



Scoped privileges flow upward through reusable account-role layers.

OBJECT TAGGING: SET BUSINESS CONTEXT ONCE

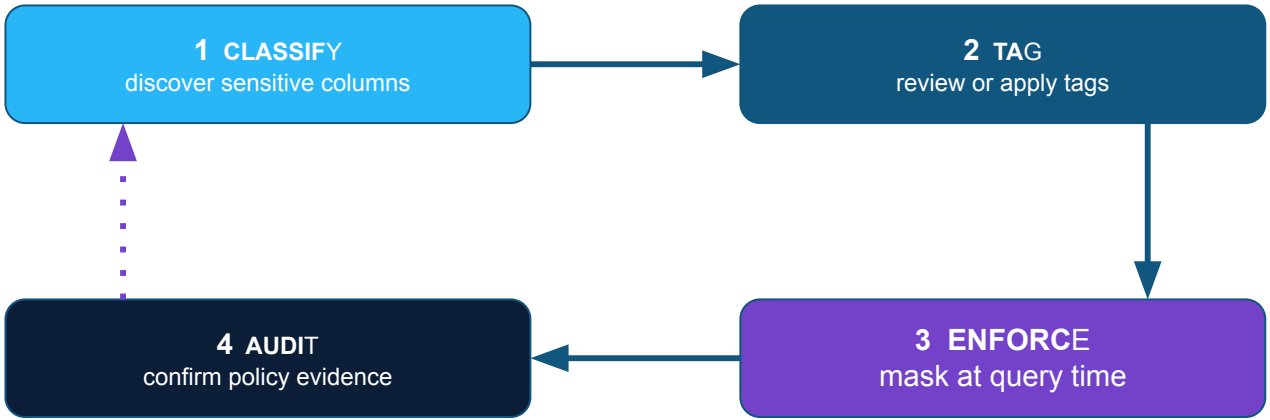
Supported descendants inherit a tag value unless it is overridden lower in the object hierarchy.



A database-level tag supplies a default; assign a lower-level value only when needed.

DATA CLASSIFICATION: FIND, REVIEW, THEN PROTECT

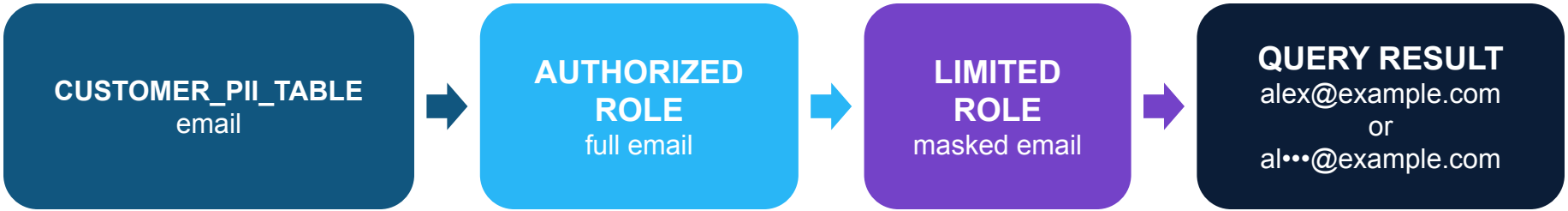
Classification finds and labels sensitive columns before policy is applied.



Automate only after reviewing detections, privileges, and policy fit.

COLUMN-LEVEL SECURITY: PROTECT THE VALUE

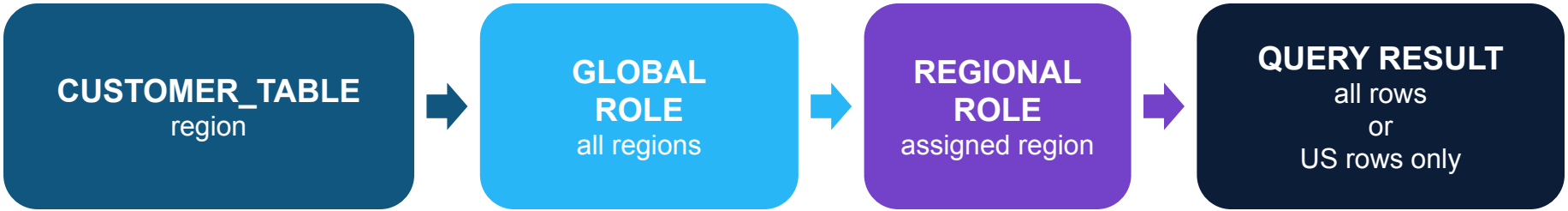
ONE COLUMN · ONE MASKING POLICY · DIFFERENT QUERY RESULTS



The masking policy changes the displayed value at query time. Stored data remains unchanged.

ROW-LEVEL SECURITY: PROTECT THE RECORD SET

ONE TABLE · ONE ROW ACCESS POLICY · DIFFERENT RETURNED ROWS



The policy evaluates each row and returns only records for which the expression is TRUE.

ACCESS HISTORY: ANSWER WHO SAW WHAT

ACCESS_HISTORY ARRAYS → FLATTEN → FILTERABLE AUDIT ROWS

ONE QUERY EVENT

```
direct_objects_accessed: [
  { objectName: "…CUSTOMER_PII_TABLE",
    columns: [customer_id, email, region] }
]
```

LATERAL FLATTEN



USER	TIME	COLUMN
J_DOE	09:14	CUSTOMERS.customer_id
J_DOE	09:14	CUSTOMERS.email
J_DOE	09:14	CUSTOMERS.region

Query events link the user, time, object, columns, and enforced policy references.

CAN WE PROVE WHAT HAPPENED?

RETURN TO THE TRUSTED DASHBOARD · FOLLOW THE SUPPORTED EVIDENCE

ONE SUPPORTED QUERY EVENT

USER
J_DOE

QUERY
trusted dashboard

OBJECT + COLUMNS
CUSTOMERS.email
CUSTOMERS.region

CONNECT



QUESTION	EVIDENCE
Who queried it?	user + query
What was accessed?	object + columns
Which controls applied?	policies_referenced

Access History provides supported evidence, not a substitute for customer-specific incident analysis.

FIVE QUESTIONS TO TAKE BACK

Use the pattern as a self-assessment before the working session.

1 Do roles map to jobs and reusable access?

2 Is sensitive data tagged and classified?

3 Are displayed values protected?

4 Are returned rows restricted?

5 Can you prove which controls were enforced?

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YOUR GOVERNANCE MODEL IS SPECIFIC

Use today's patterns as the starting point for a focused working session.

Bring your priority data domains, role model, regulatory boundaries, and one audit question.

We'll map the first practical control path with your Snowflake Account Engineer team.

Share account-specific questions today so we can use them to prepare a personalized follow-up.

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THANK YOU



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